



MY EXPERIENCE IN VISAKHAPATNAM AT LOCKDOWN

A PERSONAL JOURNEY OF COMPASSION, RESPONSIBILITY AND GRATITUDE

MY NEW BEGINNING IN VISAKHAPATNAM

At that time, I had newly joined M/s NEVCO Engineers Pvt. Ltd. on 2nd March 2020. Our client site was M/s NTPC SIMHADRI, and I was staying in Old Kajuwaka.

THE PEAK OF LOCKDOWN

During the peak period of the lockdown, I observed the deaths of three old dogs near my locality. I searched for nearby rescuers or NGOs. Luckily, I got the contact number of "Sridevi Mam". She responded to me immediately and took me to the house of a financially well-off couple.

THE RESPONSIBILITY OF FEEDING 60 STREET DOGS

The couple suggested that they could prepare packets of Chawal, Dal and Eggs for around 60 street dogs. I had to find the dogs and feed them once a day. I became excited and happily accepted this responsibility. I regularly fed them for about two and a half months. During the daytime, I distributed whatever food they prepared, and for night feeding, I spent my own money to arrange food.

GRATITUDE TO MY COMPANY

During that period, I heard that many companies were not paying salaries to their employees, some were paying only half salaries, and somewhere layoffs had happened. But my company paid me my full salary even during that difficult time. I am very thankful for that support.

THE OLD LADY AND HER TWO DOGS

Where I was staying, an old lady lived on the ground floor with two adult street dogs. One was blind and the other was unable to walk. I helped her sometimes and tried to support the dogs whenever I could.

THE KITTENS IN THE HEAVY RAIN

There, for the first time, I rescued two kittens during heavy rain at night. Later, I came to know that four more kittens and their mother cat were living near a closed building. They gradually became familiar with me, and I fed them regularly. The handicapped dogs on the ground floor would sometimes play with the kittens.

THE ACCIDENT VICTIM

During that period, one dog met with an accident and suffered a leg fracture. I took him to a veterinary clinic, where external fixation was done. I also took care of him during his recovery. He became okay before I left Old Kajuwaka.

FROM VISAKHAPATNAM TO BARH

After the lockdown period was over, I resumed my job at NTPC SIMHADRI. Then, in August 2020, my company appointed me to the NTPC BARH project.

THE LOCKDOWN OF STREET ANIMALS IN BARH





There, I experienced the lockdown situation of street animals—cows, pigs and dogs. I personally fed them. At that time, some fruit and vegetable stalls kept certain quantities outside their stalls. Their usual shop timing was from around 8 AM to a maximum of about 2 PM. After that, I arranged the available fruits and vegetables and managed to use them for feeding the animals.

CARE FOR PEOPLE LIVING ON THE ROADSIDE

Some mentally challenged people living by the roadside were also taken care of by me, even after the government distributed food twice a day. Whenever they were sick, I used to bring them into the picture and remind the food distributor about the need for medicines. Sometimes I checked their temperature and contacted a nearby clinic and the police station. They came to know about the situation and took proper action, including taking them to the nearby government hospital when it opened.

FOOD FOR STRANGERS IN NEED

While I was distributing food to street animals, some strangers living on the roadside would also ask me for food. Whenever possible, I arranged and offered them biscuits, or Chuda or Sattu with Gud and water.

MY PEACEFUL END TO EACH DAY

I returned to my room every day at around 10 PM. After having my dinner, I would peacefully sleep with my kittens. Those difficult lockdown days were exhausting, but they also gave me a deep sense of purpose. Caring for animals and people in need became a part of my everyday life.

A JOURNEY OF COMPASSION

My experience in Visakhapatnam during lockdown was not simply a chapter of my professional life. It became the beginning of a journey in which I learned that compassion does not wait for convenient circumstances. Even when the world was struggling, there were lives around me—dogs, cats, cows, pigs and vulnerable people—who needed someone to notice them. I tried, in my own small way, to be that person.

